Of course we have combined in moments that have attracted far wider attention – most notably batting to save the second Test against Australia in Adelaide in 2012 and adding 206 for the third wicket in a one-day international against Australia in August 2014 – but, for me, we were exceptional at high school.

That might seem odd, but Tiger Woods might understand.

I recently read an interview the great American golfer gave to *Time* magazine to mark his 40th birthday and he was quoted as saying: 'I peaked at 11, to be honest with you. I played 36 tournaments that year, all in California, and won them all, never lost. I probably had the cutest girlfriend in all of sixth grade. And I had straight As, no A-minuses. They were all perfect As. I've been trying to get back to that ever since.'

It might be stretching reality to suggest that Faf and I peaked at 16, but those really were the days at Affies. We relished every match, embraced every challenge and loved every minute.

We were fortunate to attend a great high school.

Everyone has their own concept of an ideal school. For me, it would be a place with outstanding facilities in an inspiring location, with plenty of importance attached to sport throughout the year, a clear identity and a strong sense of belonging, a place where nothing is more valued than a fighting spirit.

Happily for me, and for tens of thousands of others, a member of parliament named Jan Joubert and a pastor called Chris Neethling founded precisely such a school in Pretoria.

At a time when Dutch and English were the country's two official languages, Joubert and Neethling recognised a growing push to replace Dutch with Afrikaans and created the first purely Afrikaans-medium school in South Africa. The Afrikaanse Hoër Seunskool duly opened on 28 January 1920, with 44 pupils and three teachers in a house belonging to General Piet Joubert. The school soon moved east to larger premises and, in 1929, settled on its current site at No. 1 Lynnwood Road, across